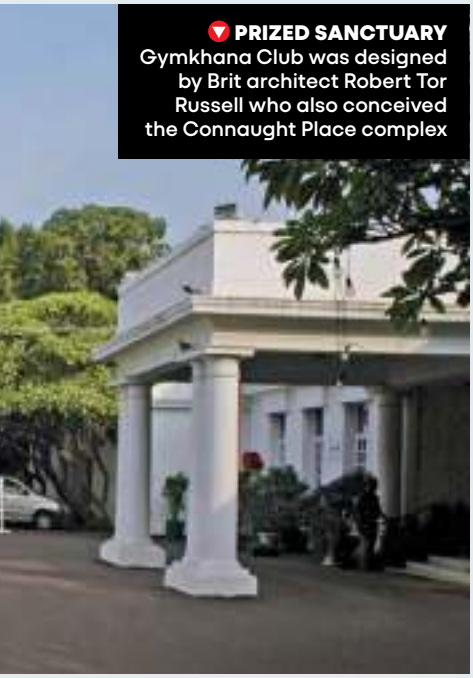


PRIZED SANCTUARY Gymkhana Club was designed by Brit architect Robert Tor Russell who also conceived the Connaught Place complex

DILIP BANERJEE

ment-appointed committee in its place, composed of, among others, Delhi BJP general secretary Kuljeet Singh Chahal, party spokesman Nalin Kohli, along with bureaucrats and security veterans.

Meanwhile, reactions from Gymkhana members have ranged from defiance to quiet resignation. Club member Rumnita Mittal scoffs at the notion of it as some sort of natural justice against the super-rich. "This is a total myth. Over half of the permanent members are retired armed forces personnel. Then, there are the ex-bureaucrats, those who have made the policy decisions. They are the ones sitting here, having a cup of tea." Legal luminaries, like former Supreme Court judge Markandeya Katju, have also weighed in, calling it an "extremely unfortunate" situation for the government to rely on a lease clause from the colonial era to evict the club.

On social media, too, a battle has been raging for days, with people arguing over legalities, fairness and the fate of one of Delhi's landmark institutions. Apart from the club's 14,000 membership base, there are also the 600 workers who now face an uncertain future. Meanwhile, the L&DO has sent another notice for dues of Rs 47 crore, much of which is from a revised lease rate. The clock is ticking, a 113-year-old institution faces a deadline. Outside, the state waits, armed with both an archaic lease and a padlock. ■

▶ GOA

A Party in Peril

Factional feud pushes Goa's rising regional outfit to the brink ahead of the 2027 assembly election

By **Dhaval S. Kulkarni**

THE REVOLUTIONARY GOANS PARTY (RGP), seen as the first genuinely pan-Goa regional outfit, is facing an existential crisis after a bitter feud between party president Manoj Parab and its lone MLA, Viresh Borkar—less than a year before the 2027 assembly election. On May 21, Parab resigned from both his post and the party, citing his inability to manage the organisation. The long-simmering rift came to a head after Parab attacked Borkar loyalists in a series of social media posts and served his party's only representative in the assembly a notice for 'anti-party activities', which he has ignored so far.

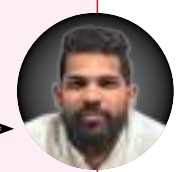
Speaking to INDIA TODAY, Borkar alleged that the rival faction wanted to "pull the curtains down" on the RGP. He also claimed that his successful agitation earlier this year against controversial land conversions had "hurt some vested interests".

Though Parab has announced his exit from active politics, speculation is rife that he could join the BJP, with even the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) reaching out to him. Borkar, too, was said to be weighing a move to the Congress, though he has clarified that he will be contesting the 2027 election as an RGP nominee.

Takeaways

- **Manoj Parab resigns from RGP president's post and party after feud with lone MLA Viresh Borkar**
- **Speculation is rife Parab could join the BJP; Borkar is said to be weighing a move to the Congress, he denies it**





A PAN-GOA 'REVOLUTION'

Born out of a youth-led movement championing the rights of 'Niz Goenkars'—sons of the soil—the RGP drew many of its founders from the ranks of the India Against Corruption (IAC) movement. After registering as a political party in 2021, it contested 38 of Goa's 40 assembly seats the following year, won the St Andre constituency in South Goa through then 28-year-old Borkar, and secured nearly 10 per cent of the vote share—behind only the BJP and the Congress.

According to activist and former state legislator Radharao Gracias, the RGP marked "the first time that Hindu groups are asserting that they are Goans", unlike older regional formations that leaned towards Maharashtrian identity politics. Yugank Naik, an assistant professor at Goa University, notes that the RGP stood apart because it drew "an equal share of Hindu and Catholic votes, that too from the lower strata of society".

The RGP's collapse could significantly alter Opposition arithmetic. In 2022, the party, along with other marginal players like the AAP and the Trinamool Congress, split anti-incumbency votes in several seats, indirectly aiding BJP wins. More recently, its refusal to align with the Congress-led bloc in the zilla panchayat polls hurt the Opposition in several seats. ■